KARL M. ASPELUND

Email: karl.aspelund@yale.edu
Website: https://karlaspelund.github.io

Academic Positions

Assistant Professor of Environmental & Natural Resource Economics, 2026–
Yale School of the Environment

Postdoctoral Environmental Fellow, 2025–2026
Harvard University Center for the Environment

Education

Ph.D., Economics, Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT) 2025

B.A., Environmental Science & Public Policy, Harvard University 2017
Magna cum laude with highest honors

Publications

Additionality & Asymmetric Information in Environmental Markets (with Anna Russo)
American Economic Review (lead article)

Working Papers

Redistribution in Environmental Permit Markets: Transfers & Efficiency Costs with Trade Restrictions

Diagnosing Spatial Policies in a Changing Commons (with Aaron Berman)

Selected Works in Progress

Aligning Community Incentives with Nature-Based Climate Solutions: Designing an Urban Tree-Planting Program in Freetown, Sierra Leone (with Dev Patel)

National Resource Management under Uncertainty (with Eduardo Souza-Rodrigues & Victor Aguirregabiria)

Valuing Input Controls under Ecological Uncertainty

Fellowships & Awards

CESifo Best Paper, Junior Workshop on Energy & Climate Economics 2026
NOAA-Sea Grant Fellowship 2022–2025
NSF Graduate Research Fellowship 2019–2024
Graduate Fellow, Minda de Gunzburg Center for European Studies at Harvard 2020–2025
Enel Endowment Prize, Best Undergraduate Thesis in Environmental Economics 2017
Environmental Science & Public Policy Undergraduate Thesis Prize 2017
Phi Beta Kappa 2016

Grants

Yale & the World Partnership Fund, $15,000 (with D. Patel) 2026
SSHRC Insight Grant, C$167,756 (with E. Souza-Rodrigues & V. Aguirregabiria) 2026
MIT Graduate Conference Travel Grant 2023
George & Obie Shultz Fund (3x) 2020–2023

Talks

2026 Delhi School of Economics; Indian Statistical Institute Delhi; TERI-SAS; UC San Diego; University of Hawai'i; UMass Amherst; CESifo Junior Workshop on Climate & Energy Economics; Academic Workshop for Icelandic Economists Abroad; TSE Energy & Climate Change Conference; Toronto Meeting on the Economics of Climate Change; World Congress of Environmental & Resource Economics; International Institute of Fisheries Economics & Trade; UW Madison AAE

2025 UIUC; Sciences Po; Toulouse School of Economics; Stockholm University IIES; LSE; UBC Sauder; Dartmouth Tuck; Yale School of the Environment; Yale Workshop on Energy Policy & Environmental Economics; NBER Summer Institute EEE; LSE Environment Week; University of Iceland

2024 UC Davis ARE; NMFS Social Science Symposium; NOAA-Sea Grant Fellows Research Symposium; Occasional Workshop in Environmental & Resource Economics

2023 NOAA-Sea Grant Fellows Research Symposium; North American Association of Fisheries Economists Forum; Academic Workshop for Icelandic Economists Abroad

Teaching

Economics of Sustainability & Natural Resources, Yale 2027-
Course number: ECON 3330/EVST 3340/ENV 804. Undergraduate course.

Microeconomic Theory & Public Policy, MIT 2023
Course number: 14.03. Undergraduate course. Teaching assistant for Prof. Tobias Salz.

Advising

PhD committee member: Lucas Epstein (YSE 3rd Year)

Service

Environmental Studies Advisory Committee (Yale College & YSE) 2026-

Professional Activities

Referee: *American Economic Review: Insights*, *Climate Change Economics*, *Environment & Development Economics*, *Journal of the Association of Environmental & Resource Economics*, *Journal of Development Economics*, *Quarterly Journal of Economics*

Grant reviewer: National Science Foundation